

Lab: Organizational Perceptual Audit

Objectives

Learning Goal: Systematically evaluate your organization's sensing capabilities, identify blind spots, and design improvements to the sensory apparatus.

This is a **case study exercise**. Work individually or in small groups.

Part 1: Sensory Channel Inventory (15 min)

List all the ways your organization currently senses its environment:

#	Sensory Channel	What It Detects	Speed	Precision (H/M/L)	Who Receives It
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					

Write your response here

Part 2: Blind Spot Analysis (15 min)

For each critical domain, assess whether your sensing is adequate:

Environment Domain	Current Sensing	Adequate?	Biggest Blind Spot
Customer needs & behavior		Yes/Partial/No	
Competitor strategy			
Technology trends			
Regulatory/political			
Talent market			
Supply chain risks			
Macroeconomic shifts			

Write your response here

Part 3: Precision Mapping (10 min)

Identify the **three signals** your organization weights most heavily (high precision) and the **three signals** it tends to ignore (low precision):

High Precision (Trusted, Acted Upon): 1. 2. 3.

Low Precision (Discounted, Ignored): 1. 2. 3.

Is this precision allocation appropriate? Are any high-precision signals overweighted? Are any low-precision signals being dangerously ignored?

Write your response here

Part 4: Active Sensing Design (15 min)

Design two **epistemic actions** — deliberate initiatives whose primary purpose is to reduce critical uncertainty:

Epistemic Action 1

Element	Detail
Uncertainty to resolve	
Action design (experiment, pilot, research)	
Expected information gain	
Cost and timeline	
Success criteria	

Epistemic Action 2

Element	Detail
Uncertainty to resolve	
Action design	
Expected information gain	
Cost and timeline	
Success criteria	

Write your response here

Part 5: Signal Flow Trace (15 min)

Choose one important signal and trace how it flows through your organization from initial sensing to executive decision:

Signal originates at: _____

↓

First receiver: _____

↓ (What changes? What is filtered?)

Second receiver: _____

↓ (What changes? What is filtered?)

Decision maker: _____

Does the signal arrive at the decision maker in the same form it was originally sensed? If not, what was lost or distorted?

Write your response here

Summary

Component	Finding
Total sensory channels identified	
Most critical blind spot	
Most misweighted signal (precision error)	
Most promising epistemic action	
Worst signal distortion point	